

Word family: **turnover / turnovers**

Base word: turnover

Plural: turnovers

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Related written form: **turn over** is a separate two-word phrasal verb and is not counted here as another noun meaning.

Your sentence:

> "It loses **turnover** during peak hours..."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **turnover** most naturally means **the amount of business or sales revenue a shop generates during a period of time**.

So the writer means that when customers occupy tables for hours while buying very little, the restaurant can serve fewer paying customers and therefore loses potential sales.

繁體中文： **營業額；一定時間內透過銷售商品或服務所產生的營業收入**

中文翻譯：

> "It loses **turnover** during peak hours..."

「它在繁忙時段會損失**營業額 / 生意額**。」

In British business English, **turnover** commonly refers to the value of goods or services sold during a period. It is not the same thing as profit. ([劍橋詞典][1])

There is, however, a closely relevant restaurant expression:

> **table turnover**

= 一張桌子在某段時間內可以接待多少批顧客 / 翻桌率

That is probably the **mechanism causing the lost turnover** in your passage: lower table turnover → fewer customers served → lower sales turnover. Restaurant-industry usage defines table turnover in terms of how many parties can be served by the available tables during a period. ([Toast POS][2])

1. **turnover** = total sales/business revenue during a period (商業) — **營業額；營業收入**

This is the passage sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Long-stay customers may reduce the restaurant’s **turnover** during peak hours.”

「長時間逗留的顧客可能會降低餐廳在繁忙時段的**營業額**。」

Practice 2

> “The company has an annual **turnover** of several million dollars.”

「這家公司每年的**營業額**達數百萬元。」

Practice 3

> “The business increased its **turnover** last year.”

「這家企業去年的**營業額**有所增加。」

turnover = 公司在某段時間內透過銷售商品 / 服務所做的生意總額

Common:

- * annual turnover
- * monthly turnover
- * total turnover
- * sales turnover
- * company turnover

Cambridge specifically labels this accounting sense as chiefly British business English. ([劍橋詞典]
[1])

2. **turnover** ≠ profit (非常重要)

Suppose a shop has:

> turnover = \$1,000,000

> expenses = \$900,000

Its profit is only:

> \$100,000

So:

****turnover = 營業額****

but:

****profit = 利潤****

A company can have:

> high turnover but low profit

= ****營業額很高，但利潤很低****

This distinction is essential for learners.

3. ****turnover = rate at which employees leave and are replaced (人事) — 員工流失 / 更替率****

A very common separate use.

Practice 4

> “The company has a high staff ****turnover****.”

「這家公司的****員工流失 / 更替率****很高。」

Practice 5

> “High employee ****turnover**** can increase recruitment costs.”

「高****員工流失率****可能增加招聘成本。」

****staff/employee turnover = 員工離職，然後由新人補上的速度 / 比例****

This does ****not**** mean employee sales or revenue. Cambridge treats employee turnover as the rate at which workers leave and are replaced. ([劍橋詞典][1])

Common:

* staff turnover

* employee turnover

* labour turnover

* turnover rate

4. **turnover** = frequent replacement/change of people (人員 / 管理層) — 人員更替；頻繁變動

The same replacement concept extends beyond ordinary employees.

Practice 6

> “There has been a rapid **turnover** of senior managers.”

「高級管理人員出現了頻繁的**更替**。」

Practice 7

> “The organisation experienced considerable leadership **turnover**.”

「這個機構的領導層出現相當大的**人事變動**。」

It can also describe residents, patients, members, office-holders, etc., depending on context.

turnover = 原有的人離開，新的人成為替代者的過程 / 速度

For strict counting, this belongs with Meaning 3.

5. **turnover** = rate at which stock is sold and replaced (庫存) — 存貨周轉；存貨周轉率

In retail and accounting, **inventory turnover / stock turnover** measures how quickly inventory is sold and replenished.

Practice 8

> “Fresh food usually requires rapid stock **turnover**.”

「新鮮食品通常需要較快的**存貨周轉**。」

Practice 9

> “The company is trying to improve inventory **turnover**.”

「公司正在設法提高**存貨周轉率**。」

inventory turnover = 存貨售出並重新補充的速度 / 次數

Cambridge separately records this commercial use as the rate at which stock is sold and replaced.
([劍橋詞典][1])

This shares the deeper concept:

> **old items leave → new items replace them**

with staff turnover.

6. **table turnover** = rate at which tables serve successive groups of customers (餐飲) — 翻桌率；餐桌周轉率

Very relevant to your passage.

Practice 10

> “Fast-food restaurants depend on relatively high table **turnover** at lunchtime.”

「快餐店在午餐時段通常依靠較高的**翻桌率 / 餐桌周轉率**。」

Practice 11

> “Customers who stay for several hours reduce table **turnover**.”

「逗留數小時的顧客會降低**翻桌率**。」

table turnover = 同一張桌子在一定時間內送走一批顧客、再接待下一批顧客的速度

A restaurant-industry formulation measures this by the number of parties served relative to the number of tables. ([Toast POS][2])

For your database, I would place this under the broader **cycling/replacement rate** branch rather than create a completely unrelated meaning.

7. **turnover** = amount/rate of buying and selling in financial markets (金融) — 成交額；成交量；交易周轉

In finance, **turnover** may refer to the amount or frequency of trading.

Practice 12

> “The market recorded heavy **turnover**.”

「市場錄得大量**成交 / 交易量**。」

This is particularly common in specialist financial writing.

Cambridge records financial-market turnover as the number/value of shares bought and sold during a period. ([劍橋詞典][1])

8. **portfolio turnover = rate at which investments are replaced (投資) — 投資組合周轉率**

An investment fund can have high or low **portfolio turnover** depending on how frequently it buys and sells holdings.

Practice 13

> “The fund has a relatively high portfolio **turnover**.”

「這隻基金的**投資組合周轉率**相對較高。」

The SEC describes portfolio turnover as changes in securities held by a portfolio and expresses the turnover rate in relation to the portfolio's average value. ([證券交易委員會][3])

Again, the central image is:

> existing holdings are sold → other holdings replace them.

9. **turnover = replacement/renewal of biological material (生物 / 醫學) — 更新 ; 周轉 ; 代謝更新**

In biology and medicine, **turnover** can describe the continual removal and replacement of cells, proteins, tissues, chemicals, etc.

Practice 14

> “Skin has a continuous process of cell **turnover**.”

「皮膚細胞會持續進行**更新 / 周轉**。」

Common technical combinations include:

* cell turnover

* protein turnover

- * bone turnover
- * tissue turnover

In cell biology, high-turnover tissues continually replace lost cells through proliferation. ([國家生技信息中心][4])

****turnover = 舊的生物成分被分解、死亡或移除，再由新的成分補充的更新過程****

This is an established scientific extension of the replacement-cycle sense.

10. ****turnover = general replacement/renewal cycle (一般) — 更替；周轉****

The same concept can extend to many things.

Practice 15

> “The building has a high ****turnover**** of tenants.”

「這棟大廈的租戶****更替率****很高。」

Practice 16

> “There is constant ****turnover**** among volunteers.”

「義工人員經常****更替****。」

The object tells you what is cycling:

- * staff → 員工流失 / 更替
- * tenants → 租戶更替
- * stock → 存貨周轉
- * tables → 翻桌
- * cells → 細胞更新
- * investments → 投資組合周轉

These are not seven unrelated meanings. They share one strong mental concept:

> ****one set leaves/is used up and another replaces it****

11. ****turnover = loss of possession to the opposing team (體育) — 失誤失去球權；球權轉換****

This is a genuinely distinct sports meaning.

Practice 17

> “The team committed too many **turnovers**.”

「這支球隊出現太多次**失誤失去球權**。」

Practice 18

> “The defender forced a **turnover**.”

「那名防守球員迫使對方**失去球權**。」

In sports such as basketball and American football, a turnover occurs when one team loses possession and the other gains it. ([劍橋詞典][1])

Depending on the sport, the precise mechanism differs.

12. **turnover** = folded filled pastry (食物) — 餡餅；摺疊酥皮點心

A completely unrelated everyday noun.

A **turnover** is a piece of pastry folded over a filling and sealed.

Practice 19

> “She bought an apple **turnover**.”

「她買了一個**蘋果酥餡餅 / 蘋果酥角**。」

Practice 20

> “The bakery sells fruit **turnovers**.”

「這間麵包店出售水果餡的**摺疊酥皮點心**。」

Cambridge and Collins both record the pastry sense, especially familiar in **apple turnover**. ([劍橋詞典][1])

13. **turnover** = act/result of turning over, reversal, or change (較低頻) — 翻轉；顛倒；轉變

There is also a broader noun sense relating literally or figuratively to something being turned over

or reversed.

This can include:

- * a physical overturning;
- * reversal of position;
- * change from one arrangement or management to another.

Collins records this older/broader branch alongside the more specialized modern senses. ([Collins 字典][5])

For everyday learners, however, this is much less useful than:

- * business turnover
- * staff turnover
- * sports turnover
- * pastry turnover

So I would **recognize but not prioritize** it.

Important distinction: **turnover vs revenue**

In British business English, they are often very close.

turnover

= total value of sales/business during a period.

revenue

= income generated by business activities.

For many ordinary company contexts:

- > annual turnover
- > annual revenue

may refer to broadly the same top-line figure.

But **revenue** is much more internationally transparent, especially in American business English.

Important distinction: **turnover vs profit**

This is the crucial one:

turnover

= money generated from sales **before deducting business expenses**

profit

= what remains after relevant costs have been deducted

So:

> high turnover $\neq$ high profit

A restaurant may have high turnover but very thin profit margins.

Important distinction: **turnover vs sales**

sales

can mean:

- * sales transactions;
- * units sold;
- * money earned from sales.

turnover

in the business-revenue sense generally refers to the overall amount of business done during the accounting period.

In many contexts:

> sales turnover

makes the intended meaning explicit.

Important distinction: **turnover vs table turnover**

This is particularly important for your passage.

business turnover

> how much business/sales revenue the restaurant generates

table turnover

> how quickly each table becomes available for another group

Example:

> Low table turnover can reduce business turnover.

「翻桌率低可能會令營業額下降。」

That is essentially what your passage is describing.

Important distinction: **turnover vs profit margin**

turnover

= total sales amount

profit margin

= profit expressed relative to revenue/sales

They measure completely different things.

Important distinction: **staff turnover vs staff shortage**

staff turnover

= employees frequently leave and are replaced.

staff shortage

= there are not enough employees.

A workplace can have:

* high turnover but enough staff;

* low turnover but still have a staff shortage.

Important distinction: **turnover vs churn**

In modern business:

employee turnover

is the standard HR expression.

churn

is especially common for customers/subscribers leaving a service, although it may sometimes be used informally for employees as well.

> customer churn

> employee turnover

Grammar and countability note

The grammar depends strongly on the sense.

Business revenue

Often uncountable:

> annual turnover

> turnover increased

Employee/replacement rate

Usually uncountable:

> high staff turnover

Sports event

Countable:

> a turnover

> five turnovers

Pastry

Countable:

- > an apple turnover
- > two turnovers

So **turnovers** most naturally suggests either:

- * several sports possession losses, or
- * several pastries,

unless the context clearly indicates separate business turnovers.

Spelling note: **turnover** vs **turn over**

These are different grammatical units.

turnover — one word

noun:

- > staff turnover
- > annual turnover
- > a turnover in basketball
- > an apple turnover

turn over — two words

verb/phrasal verb:

- > turn over the page
- > turn over in bed

There are also business uses such as a company **turning over** a certain amount or stock **turning over**, but because your database normally treats phrasal verbs separately, I would not fold all **turn over** meanings into this entry. Cambridge confirms the closely related business verb uses for revenue and stock replacement. ([劍橋詞典][6])

Family-extension note

The morphological family of the one-word noun is small:

* **turnover**
* **turnovers**

Most of its richness comes from compounds:

* annual turnover
* sales turnover
* staff turnover
* employee turnover
* labour turnover
* inventory turnover
* stock turnover
* table turnover
* customer turnover
* portfolio turnover
* cell turnover
* bone turnover
* turnover rate

A broad audit shows that many of these should **not** be stored as separate meanings. Most belong to one underlying concept:

> **how quickly people/things leave, are used, sold, or removed and are then replaced**

The major exceptions are **sales revenue**, **sports loss of possession**, and **the pastry**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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turnover — business	公司 / 商戶在一定時期內透過銷售商品或服務所產生的營業額
staff turnover	員工離職並由新人取代的速度 / 比例；員工流失 / 更替率
general turnover	某批人 / 物離開、被使用或移除後由另一批取代的周轉 / 更替過程
inventory turnover	存貨售出並重新補貨的速度 / 次數；存貨周轉率
table turnover	餐桌在一定時間內接待不同批顧客的速度；翻桌率
financial-market turnover	某段時間內金融資產的交易額 / 成交量
portfolio turnover	投資組合持倉被買賣、更換的程度 / 比率
cell/tissue turnover	舊細胞 / 組織成分被移除後由新成分取代的更新過程
turnover — sport	因失誤等令己方失去球權、由對手取得球權
turnover — pastry	把麵皮摺起包住餡料的酥皮 / 餡餅
turnover — physical/reversal	翻轉、顛倒或轉變；較低頻的一般義

For your original sentence

> "It loses **turnover** during peak hours..."

The most likely intended meaning is:

turnover = 餐廳在繁忙時段原本可以從一批又一批顧客身上取得的營業額 / 生意額

So:

> **lose turnover**

= **損失營業額 / 少做生意**

The writer is probably **not** using bare `turnover` to mean “翻桌率” directly. If that were the intended operational metric, clearer English would be:

> **reduce table turnover**

The causal chain in the passage is:

> customers occupy tables for hours

> → **table turnover falls**

> → fewer new diners can be served

> → **sales turnover/revenue falls**

For your database, I would count **5** genuinely useful core meanings:

1. **business sales/revenue during a period**
2. **rate/process of people or things leaving/being used and being replaced** — staff, inventory, tables, cells, tenants, portfolios
3. **financial trading volume/activity** — specialist extension of #2, worth surfacing
4. **sports: loss of possession**
5. **folded filled pastry**

I would keep the older/general **turning over/reversal** sense as lower priority, while treating **staff turnover, inventory turnover, table turnover, cell turnover, portfolio turnover** as important domain realizations of the same replacement/cycling concept rather than artificially splitting all of them into separate core meanings.

[1]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/turnover?utm_source=chatgpt.com
"TURNOVER | English meaning - Cambridge Dictionary"

[2]: https://pos.toasttab.com/resources/how-to-increase-restaurant-sales?utm_source=chatgpt.com
"How to Measure and Increase Restaurant Sales | Toast POS"

[3]: https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/916403/000119312526177141/f44844d1.htm?utm_source=chatgpt.com "485BPOS"

[4]: https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/books/NBK9906/?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Cell Proliferation in Development and Differentiation - The Cell - NCBI Bookshelf"

[5]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/us/dictionary/english/turnover?utm_source=chatgpt.com
"TURNOVER definition in American English | Collins English Dictionary"

[6]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/turn-over?utm_source=chatgpt.com
"TURN OVER | definition in the Cambridge English Dictionary"